

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/9: Canon and school taxonomy

THREEFOLD CANON: UPANISADS + BHAGAVAD GITA + BRAHMA SUTRA

Badarayana systematizes; rival commentaries build distinct schools

Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance

Visistadvaita: qualified unity; selves and world are real modes

Dvaita: God, selves and world are eternally different realities

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/9: Ultimate reality, Lord and self

ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) / LORD (ISVARA) / TRUE SELF (ATMAN)

Advaita -> qualityless ultimate reality; empirical Lord under illusion

Visistadvaita -> personal qualified ultimate reality with inseparable modes

Dvaita -> independent Lord and permanently dependent selves

trap: the three schools do not use the same word with the same ontology

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/9: Witness, reflection and knowledge

WAKING -> DREAM -> DEEP SLEEP -> NON-DUAL WITNESS

original-reflection is a later explanatory family, not literal optics

hearing -> reflection -> deep contemplation stabilizes identity-knowledge

Ramanuja: atomic knower with expanding attributive consciousness

trap: do not call Lord (īśvara) both original and reflection without naming the model

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/9: World, causation and ignorance

### ADVAITA: APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVADA)

Ramanuja: real transformation of dependent modes within Ultimate reality (Brahman)'s body

Madhva: God efficient cause; dependent primordial matter material cause

indescribable illusion (māyā) projects; ignorance (avidyā) misidentifies

vivarta develops causal dependence but rejects real transformation

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/9: Superimposition and great statement

SUPERIMPOSITION (ADHYASA) → SELF/NON-SELF CONFUSION → BONDAGE

great statement 'That Thou Art' requires discarding incompatible attributes  
indescribable-error theory explains rope-snake without making error unreal  
knowledge removes ignorance; it does not produce the already-real self  
pressure: if ignorance is indefinable, its locus and removal remain contested

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/9: Qualified non-dualism

INSEPARABLE DEPENDENCE (ABHITHAKASIDDHI)

selves and world are real but cannot exist apart from ultimate reality

body-soul relation: the whole controls and supports its real modes

action and knowledge prepare; devotion/surrender and grace liberate

attributive consciousness expands without loss of individuality

strength: unity without illusionism; limit: plurality may qualify absoluteness

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/9: Dualism and fivefold difference

### FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PANCATWIDHA BHEDA)

God-self | God-world | self-self | self-world | world-world

difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced

God is efficient, not material cause; souls and matter remain dependent

liberation preserves hierarchy, difference and blissful service

strength: robust realism; limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/9: Wider Vedanta and liberation

VISISTADVAITA → COMMUNION; DVAITA → GRADED ETERNAL SERVICE

Vallabha: unchanged real manifestation + grace-nourished devotion

Caitanya: inconceivable difference-non-difference + divine love

Nimbarka matter: ordinary matter + divine matter + time

never collapse the 2018 liberation comparison into generic devotion



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/9: PYQ answer synthesis

DEFINE COMMON QUESTION -> BUILD THREE COLUMN CONTRAST -> TEST OBJECTIONS

ultimate reality -> Lord/self -> world -> ignorance/error -> liberation

use one precise doctrine and one rival criticism for each school

state what each theory preserves and what explanatory cost it pays

qualified verdict: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different pressures